

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF NEW YORK

-----X
KALONGI MAHON,

Plaintiff,

AMENDED COMPLAINT

Index No. 151166/2022

-against-

CITY OF NEW YORK, OLIVER BALENA, JEONG
AN and BRIAN BRADSHAW,

Defendants.
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Plaintiff, Mr. Kalongi Mahon, by his attorneys, **SIM & DEPAOLA LLP**, for his complaint against the Defendants, CITY OF NEW YORK, OLIVER BALENA, JEONG AN and BRIAN BRADSHAW, alleges and states as follows:

1. This is a civil rights action, in which Plaintiff seeks relief, vis-à-vis 42 U.S.C. §§ 1981, 1983, 1985, 1986 and 1988, the laws of the State of New York, in addition to the self-executing clauses or implied private causes of action within the New York State Constitution, for the violations of his civil rights, as guaranteed and protected by the First, Fourth, Fifth, Sixth and Fourteenth Amendments to the Constitution of the United States, as well as the Laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

2. The following claims arise from a December 17, 2020, incident, in which defendants, acting under color of state law, unlawfully stopped, questioned, searched, arrested and detained plaintiff in the vicinity of 159 East 125 Street, City, County, and State of New York. Plaintiff was subsequently removed to 25th Precinct, then to Central Bookings, and later released after being criminal arraigned. As a result, Plaintiff was deprived of his liberty and suffered various physical, emotional and psychological injuries. Plaintiff was wrongfully detained over the course of two (2)

days. Plaintiff was maliciously prosecuted and denied due process of law, until all adverse charges were dismissed as legally insufficient.

3. At all times here mentioned, Defendants were acting under color of state law, to wit, under color of the statutes, ordinances, regulations, policies, customs and usages of the City and State of New York.

4. Plaintiff has served a notice of claim upon the City of New York in compliance with Section fifty-e of the New York General Municipal Law (GML § 50-e).

5. At least thirty (30) days have elapsed since the service of said notice, and adjustment or payment thereof has been neglected or refused.

6. Plaintiff seeks monetary damages (compensatory and punitive), an award of costs and attorney's fees, together with such other or further relief as the Court may deem just and proper.

PARTIES

7. Plaintiff, Mr. Kalongi Mahon ("Mr. Mahon"), is an African American male who resides in The Bronx, New York.

8. Defendant, City of New York ("City"), is a municipal corporation organized under the laws of the State of New York.

9. At all times relevant hereto, defendant City, acting through the New York City Police Department ("NYPD"), was responsible for the policy, practice, supervision, implementation, and conduct of all NYPD matters and was responsible for the appointment, screening, hiring, training, supervision, discipline, retention and conduct of all NYPD personnel, including police officers, detectives, investigators, sergeants, lieutenants and other supervisory officers or officials, as well as the individually named NYPD defendants herein.

10. At all times here relevant herein, Defendant City, was responsible for enforcing the rules or regulations of the NYPD, and for ensuring that the NYPD personnel obey the laws and constitutions of the United States and the State of New York.

11. At all relevant times, Defendants, JEONG AN (“AN”), OLIVER BALENA (“BALENA”) and BRIAN BRADSHAW (“BRADSHAW”), were a police officers, detectives, sergeants, supervisors or policymakers employed by the NYPD. Defendant BALENA was assigned last to the 25 Pct, under Tax Reg. No 946444 and Shield No. 31185 but has been inactive or retired since 2021. Defendant BRADSHAW is a sergeant presently assigned to the Internal Affairs Bureau, under Tax Reg. No. 948306 and Shield No. 2004. Defendants AN, BALENA and BRADSHAW are being sued in their individual and official capacities.

12. At all relevant times, defendants were acting under color of state law, to wit, the statutes, ordinances, regulations, policies, customs or usages of the City or State of New York.

FACTUAL CHARGES

13. On December 17, 2019, at approximately 3:50 p.m., in the vicinity of 159 East 125 Street, City, County, and State of New York., Mr. Mahon was illegally stopped, seized and searched, detained, and arrested, by defendants, including BALENA, AN and BRADSHAW.

14. On said date and time, Plaintiff was lawfully present as a pedestrian on the sidewalk within the vicinity of said location of the complained-of-incident right after finishing a session or appointment for his health assistance program with Harlem East Life.

15. On said date and time, Plaintiff was smoking a cigarette and had not committed any unlawful conduct nor was there any indication of the commission of unlawful conduct whatsoever.

16. Defendants, including BALENA, AN and BRADSHAW, then illegally approached and stopped Plaintiff without probable cause, reasonable suspicion, or any justification whatsoever as to unlawful conduct on the part of Plaintiff.

17. Defendants, including BALENA, AN and BRADSHAW, then aggressively grabbed the cigarette from Plaintiff's hands without asking, demanding, and furthermore, without reasonable suspicion, probable cause, or any legal justification whatsoever.

18. Defendants, including BALENA, AN and BRADSHAW, then stated to Plaintiff and a few unknown individuals nearby, all of whom were waiting outside East Life Harlem, that if anyone was on parole, then they would be taken to the precinct.

19. Defendants, including BALENA, AN and BRADSHAW, then demanded and took Plaintiff's ID, went to their police vehicle, returned and accused Plaintiff of a criminal offense without reasonable suspicion, probable cause, or any legal justification whatsoever.

20. Defendants, including BALENA, AN and BRADSHAW, then illegally seized and detained Plaintiff without probable cause, reasonable suspicion, or any justification whatsoever as to unlawful conduct on the part of Plaintiff.

21. Defendants, including BALENA, AN and BRADSHAW, without any investigation into criminal activity and without observing Plaintiff commit any criminal offense, proceeded to conduct an illegal search of his person.

22. Defendants, including BALENA, AN and BRADSHAW, then proceeded to violently contort Plaintiff's arms behind his back so that they could apply metal handcuffs, disregarding Plaintiff's complaints that the cuffs were placed on too tightly causing him significant discomfort and pain.

23. Defendants, including BALENA, AN and BRADSHAW, ignored all of plaintiff's pleas to loosen the handcuffs, which resulted in plaintiff's wrists and hands sustaining loss of feeling, redness, and swelling.

24. Defendants, including BALENA, AN and BRADSHAW, then placed Plaintiff in a police vehicle and forcibly removed him against his will to the 25 Precinct.

25. Defendants, including BALENA, AN and BRADSHAW, then fingerprinted, photographed, retina-scanned, and searched or strip-searched Plaintiff before placing him in a dank and dirty cell where he was illegally detained against his will for approximately five (5) hours, before being transported to Central Booking where he was fingerprinted, photographed, retina-scanned, searched or strip-searched with attendant cavity inspection again and then placed in a dank and dirty cell for approximately six (6) hours before he was criminally arraigned.

26. Defendants, including BALENA, AN and BRADSHAW, caused a criminal prosecution to be initiated and thereafter maintained against Plaintiff, under New York Criminal Court Docket No. CR-039790-19NY, by forwarding fabricated, false, fictitious or otherwise fraudulent evidence, information or attestations of fact, namely that Defendant AN recovered a quantity of an illicit controlled substance commonly known as 'K2' from Plaintiff's hand and that Defendant BALENA determined the substance to be based on his experience and training with respect to K2 and that the arrest, recovery and controlled substance determination was conducted un the supervision of Defendant BRADSHAW who formally approved all aspects of Plaintiff's arrest and subsequent detention.

27. Defendants, including BALENA, AN and BRADSHAW, lacked any probable cause or reasonable suspicion to arrest Plaintiff, because Defendants never observed Plaintiff commit any crime or violation of the law.

28. Due to the lack of probable cause for the seizure of Plaintiff's person, the aforementioned conduct constituted the completed torts of Assault and Battery by Defendants.

29. Defendants, including BALENA, AN and BRADSHAW, knowingly, maliciously, and intentionally engaged in the fabrication of false and fictitious evidence, observations, events and occurrences, which Defendants falsely attributed to Plaintiff before forwarding to prosecutors.

30. Defendants, including BALENA, AN and BRADSHAW, engaged in fraud, the suppression of evidence, perjury, and a gross deviation from acceptable police conduct and other conduct undertaken in bad faith.

31. Plaintiff asserts that Defendants, including BALENA, AN and BRADSHAW, falsely arrested, wrongfully detained, and maliciously prosecuted Plaintiff with the full knowledge that he had committed no crimes or violations of the law.

32. Plaintiff, therefore, asserts that due to the clear absence of any viable probable cause to warrant his criminal prosecution, at any point, he was denied his rights to a fair trial and due process and was maliciously prosecuted from the moment of his arraignment, until the criminal proceeding under New York Criminal Court Docket No. CR-039790-19NY, was irrefutably terminated in favor of Plaintiff when all adverse charges were outright dismissed and sealed on the merits on or about February 18, 2020 pursuant to section 160.50 of the New York Criminal Procedure Law.

33. As a result, Plaintiff was caused to be unlawfully, involuntarily, and continuously detained by Defendants, including BALENA, AN and BRADSHAW, over the course of two (2) days for approximately eleven (11) hours, until his release from physical custody on or about December 18, 2019.

34. As a result, Plaintiff was caused be in violation of his parole, and consequently, his parole officer banned him from being within ten (10) miles of the location arrest where he was receiving treatment for his drug addiction at East Life Harlem, causing Plaintiff to experience significant emotional distress on his path towards sobriety and a healthier, safe lifestyle.

35. As a result, Plaintiff could not be seen by his doctor, who was currently treating him for a hernia, causing Plaintiff to experience further emotional distress and unnecessary pain.

36. At all times relevant hereto, Defendants, including BALENA, AN and BRADSHAW, were involved in the decision to stop, seize, and arrest Plaintiff without reasonable suspicion or probable cause, or failed to intervene when they observed others doing so in the absence of any reasonable suspicion or probable cause.

37. At all times relevant hereto, Defendants, including BALENA, AN and BRADSHAW, subjected Plaintiff to excessive force, or failed to intervene when they observed others subjecting Plaintiff to excessive force.

38. Defendants, including BALENA, AN and BRADSHAW, arrested and caused a criminal prosecution to be initiated against plaintiff, because of their desires to use plaintiff's arrest and criminal prosecution to incur additional overtime compensation, benefits and career favor from the superior officers, to avoid adverse consequences associated with failing to meet NYPD departmental arrest quotas, and also to conceal their egregious violations of proper police procedures and gross misconduct, including their fabrications of non-existent observations, evidence and information.

39. Defendants, including BALENA, AN and BRADSHAW, arrested, applied excessive force and initiated a malicious prosecution against plaintiff in retaliation for plaintiff's exertion of his constitutional right to freely express his opinion and inquiries, namely plaintiff's displeasure with

the manner in which defendants addressed him and his polite request for an explanation of their conduct.

40. As a result, Plaintiff's mental health issues were aggravated and developed a severe fear of police officers, which prevented him from venturing from his house for a period of time and has effectively permanently chilled his desire and ability to communicate with police officers.

41. Defendants, including BALENA, AN and BRADSHAW, unlawfully targeted and decided to stop and effect unlawful seizures of plaintiff due to solely to his status as a Black or African American male.

42. Defendants, including BALENA, AN and BRADSHAW, engaged in a conspiracy to falsely arrest and maliciously prosecute plaintiff by personally conferring with each other, regarding the fabrication of the aforementioned non-existent evidence and observations, as well the manner and means by which said fabrications would be forwarded to the District Attorney's Office.

43. Plaintiff asserts that the Defendants, including BALENA, AN and BRADSHAW, who violated plaintiff's civil rights, are part of a larger pattern and practice of similar misconduct, which is so widespread, pervasive and consistent throughout the NYPD and the City of New York that the commission such constitutionally violative behavior has become tantamount to an official policy or custom within the NYPD and City of New York or, at the very least, conclusive evidence that the City and the NYPD have either tacitly approved of such egregious wrongdoings or that they have become deliberately indifferent to the civil rights of those who may come into contact with their police officers.

44. The individually named defendants herein, as well as other officers serving in the employ of the NYPD and City of New York, have blatantly, shamelessly, consistently and repeatedly

engaged in conduct violative of the civil rights guaranteed and protected by Constitution of the United States, in addition to the laws and Constitution of the State of New York, all without incurring any ramifications for such misconduct and, ostensibly, with the full and complete blessing of the NYPD, the City of New York and their respective policymakers and supervisors.

45. *The New York Times*, as well as numerous other reputable journalistic enterprises, have reported on the widespread corruption within the NYPD and City of New York, particularly the incredibly disconcerting proclivity of many NYPD officers to lie about subject matters that are materially relevant to criminal prosecutions, including the complete fabrication of arrest evidence and witnesses. Also detailed, is the NYPD's obstinate refusal to effectuate corrective or preventive measures to combat the inevitable recurrence of such misdeeds, and perhaps most troubling, the NYPD's alarming tendency to, instead, reward and promote these officers, including those who were inculcated via incontrovertible evidence, such as video evidence.

46. The constitutionally repugnant behavior that persists within the ranks of the NYPD results from the NYPD's own policies, rules and procedures, namely the NYPD's incredibly flawed and illegal use of arrest quotas. Despite its illegality, such policies remain system in throughout the NYPD and its individual commands. The NYPD, however, was not content in compelling its officers to effect as many arrests as possible, regardless of the presence of any legal right to do, it promulgated various subsets of quotas, which are predicated on race, color or ethnicity. Additionally, the NYPD, its supervisors or policymakers would assign varying point values to arrests, which were, again, impermissibly based upon the arrestee's race, color or ethnicity. Unsurprisingly, officers would be better rewarded for minority arrests or summonses. This egregious conduct has reported by numerous respected media outlets and publications and has

even formed the basis for federal lawsuits against the City and the NYPD, which were commenced by its own employee officers.

47. On June 17, 2020, the *New York Daily News* published an article, by Graham Rayman, entitled “Brooklyn Cop Claims he was Punished for not Meeting Arrest Quotas, Refusing to Take Responsibility for Controversial Arrest in which he Wasn’t Involved,” describing allegations from an NYPD Police Officer, Terrence Dickerson, that he was retaliated against by the NYPD for refusing to adhere to mandatory racially based arrest quotas and for his refusal to accept responsibility for a controversial and publicized arrest via the excessive force, despite the fact that he was not even at the scene.

48. Another article with a title that speaks for itself, also published by the *New York Daily News*, on December 5, 2019, and written by Graham Rayman, is entitled “Ex-Cop Details NYPD ‘Collar Quotas’—Arrest Black and Hispanic Men, ‘No Cuffs on Soft Targets’ of Jews, Asians, Whites: Court Docs.”

49. *The New York Times*, on December 6, 2019, published an article by Joseph Goldstein and Ashley Southall, entitled “I Got Tired of Hunting Black and Hispanic People,” which revealed a disturbing account from a different NYPD Police Officer, Anthony Diaz, describing a police force that measures the quality of police work by the quantity of minority arrests.

50. On March 18, 2018, *The New York Times* published an explosive article, entitled “Promotions, Not Punishments for Officers Accused of Lying,” written by Joseph Goldstein. Mr. Goldstein shines a light on the multitude of flaws within the CCRB and the NYPD, highlighting the fact that the substantiation of a claim against an officer will invariably rely on the presence of incontrovertible proof against the officer. Due to the rarity availability of this type of evidence, an alarmingly small percentage of officer misconduct claims are substantiated. The CCRB is further

handicapped by a terribly designed system that requires evidence of a virtually indisputable nature to substantiate any claim against an officer. The article also details the NYPD's persistent reluctance to investigate or discipline officers who lie and even posits that this reluctance is a significant cause of the lying pandemic within the NYPD. The article references various officers and detectives who were the subject of credible accusations relating to the officers' intentionally false statements, with some allegations coming from federal and state judges.

51. On September 12, 2019, *The New York Times* published another article by Joseph Goldstein, entitled "Officers Said They Smelled Pot. The Judge Called Them Liars." Unsurprisingly, this article dealt with the unusually high frequency of officers using the odor of marijuana to excuse a search that conspicuously does not result in the recovery of any marijuana. It should not require an article in *The New York Times* to call attention to such patently disingenuous tactics, but has become necessary for a variety of reasons, including the NYPD's failure to correct such behavior, the willingness of prosecutors and judges to credit the lying officers and the increasing rate of occurrence.

52. On April 24, 2019, *The New York Times* published an article, entitled "Detective's Lies Sent Three People to Prison, Prosecutors Charge," by Sean Piccolo, detailing the lies of NYPD Second Grade Detective Joseph Franco and how those lies resulted in the imprisonment of at least three innocent people. The article described how Det. Franco lied about observing drug transactions on at least three separate occasions, lies that were only uncovered through contradictory video evidence. Det. Franco's lies resulted in the innocent individuals each being sentenced to prison terms in excess of one-year.

53. Other articles include: (i) "Testilying' by Police: A Stubborn Problem.," by Joseph Goldstein, *The New York Times*, March 18, 2018; (ii) "New York Detective Charged with Faking

Lineup Results,” by Joseph Goldstein, *The New York Times*, February 17, 2018; (iii) “He Excelled as a Detective, Until Prosecutors Stopped Believing Him,” by Joseph Goldstein, *The New York Times*, October 17, 2017; (iv) “Review Board Notes Rise in New York Police Officers’ False Statement,” by J. David Goodman, *The New York Times*, May 14, 2015; (v) “In Brooklyn Gun Cases, Suspicion Turns to the Police,” by Stephanie Clifford, *The New York Times*, December 11, 2014; (vi) “Detective is Found Guilty of Planting Drugs,” by Tim Stelloh, *The New York Times*, November 1, 2011; and (vii) “The Drugs? They Came from the Police,” by Jim Dwyer, *The New York Times*, October 13, 2011.

54. The NYPD has a longstanding and ignominious record of failing to discipline its officers, or even entertaining allegations of wrongdoing against them. On June 26, 2019, *The New York Times* published an article, entitled “2,495 Reports of Police Bias. Not One Was Deemed Valid by the N.Y.P.D.” This article reported that within the last five (5) years, almost 2,500 separate individuals have filed formal complaints with the NYPD alleging that an officer acted with bias toward them, with not a single one being substantiated by the NYPD. Such a finding is plainly incredible and obviously the result of deliberately poor or nonexistent investigatory protocols. The report further impugned the NYPD’s commitment to combat the prejudices and the biases exhibited by many of its officers.

55. Upon information and belief, the NYPD, the City of New York, and their respective policymakers, officials or supervisors have imposed, tacitly approved or acquiesced to policies, customs, or patterns and practices within the NYPD that resulted in plaintiff’s arrest without probable cause.

56. Upon information and belief, the NYPD, the City of New York, and their respective policymakers or supervisors have failed to provide adequate training regarding the identification of probable cause, reasonable suspicion or the appropriate amount of force to be used.

57. Defendants' actions, pursuant to plaintiff's underlying arrest, which occurred without even the semblance of probable cause, were so blatantly violative of plaintiff's civil rights that the tacit approval of identical or similar acts by the policymakers or supervisors of the NYPD and the City of New York, as well as their deliberate indifference towards the rights of any individuals who may come into contact with defendants, should be inferred, because such flagrant deprivations of constitutionally protected rights could not and would not occur without the tacit approval or deliberate indifference regarding the commission of such violations by the policymakers or supervisors of the NYPD and City of New York.

58. Upon information and belief, further details and facts, relating to the unlawful policies, customs or patterns and practices of the NYPD, City of New York and their respective policymakers, supervisors, police officers or employees, will become known after the completion of discovery, as such information is presently within the exclusive possession of defendants, the NYPD and City of New York.

59. Upon information and belief, the personnel files, records and disciplinary histories of the officer defendants will reveal a history of Constitutional violations indicative of defendant City's knowledge that the individual officer defendants were unfit for employment as NYPD officers, or for employment in general, and that the probability of the individually named defendants committing similar violations in the future was extremely high.

60. Upon information and belief, said personnel files, records and disciplinary histories will conclusively show that the City and the NYPD were fully aware of defendants' past constitutional

violations, the unacceptably high probability for the recurrence of similar transgressions, the unreasonably dangerous situations that were likely to result from their hiring or retention, as well as their unsuitability for employment as law enforcement officers, or for employment in general, and that the NYPD and City of New York failed to engage in any preventive or corrective action intended to diminish the likelihood of recurrence for such violations, which is tantamount to the City's tacit approval of such misconduct or the City's deliberate indifference towards the civil rights of those who may interact with its employees, including BALENA, AN and BRADSHAW.

61. Upon information and belief, the individually named defendants have combined to be named as defendants in numerous lawsuits that have accused them of committing violations similar or identical to those alleged herein, all of which have resulted no disciplinary or corrective action of any kind.

62. Upon information and belief, the NYPD and City of New York and have failed, or outright refused, to correct the individually named defendants' predilections to engage in unconstitutional behavior or attempt to prevent the recurrence of such misconduct

63. The aforementioned acts of Defendants, including BALENA, AN and BRADSHAW, directly or proximately resulted in the deprivation or violation of plaintiff's civil rights, as guaranteed and protected by the First, Fourth, Fifth, Sixth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, as well as the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

64. As a direct or proximate result of said acts, plaintiff was caused to suffer the loss of his liberty, irreparable reputational harm, loss of earnings and potential earnings, physical injury, as well as severe and permanent emotional distress, including fear, embarrassment, humiliation, traumatization, frustration, extreme inconvenience, and anxiety.

FIRST CAUSE OF ACTIONFree Speech Retaliation Claim Under
New York State Law

65. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.
66. Plaintiff engaged in speech and activities protected under Article I § 8 of the New York Constitution.
67. Defendants committed impermissible or unlawful actions against plaintiff that were motivated or substantially caused by plaintiff's constitutionally protected speech or activities.
68. Defendants' retaliatory actions against plaintiff resulted in the deprivation of his liberty and the initiation of criminal charges against him.
69. Defendants' retaliatory actions adversely affected Plaintiff's protected speech or activities by physically or procedurally preventing him from further pursuing said protected speech or activities or by chilling his desire to further participate or engage in protected speech or activities.
70. Accordingly, defendants violated Plaintiff's right to engage in protected speech or activities, under Article I § 8 of the New York Constitution.
71. Defendant City, as employer of the individual defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoings, under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.
72. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, plaintiff sustained damages.

SECOND CAUSE OF ACTIONFirst Amendment Retaliation Claim Under
42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

73. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.
74. Plaintiff engaged in speech and activities that were protected by the First Amendment.
75. Defendants committed impermissible or unlawful actions against plaintiff that were motivated or substantially caused by Plaintiff's constitutionally protected speech or activities.

76. Defendants' retaliatory actions against Plaintiff resulted in the deprivation of his liberty and the initiation of criminal charges against him.

77. Defendants' retaliatory actions adversely affected plaintiff's protected speech or activities by physically or procedurally preventing him from further pursuing said protected speech or activities, or by chilling his desire to further participate or engage in protected speech or activities.

78. Accordingly, defendants violated Plaintiff's rights under the First Amendment.

79. As a direct or proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained damages.

THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION

Unreasonable Search and Seizure Under New York State Law

80. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

81. Defendants subjected plaintiff and his property to unreasonable searches and seizures without a valid warrant and without reasonable suspicion or probable cause do so.

82. Plaintiff was conscious and fully aware of the unreasonable searches and seizures to his person and property.

83. Plaintiff did not consent to the unreasonable searches and seizures to his person or property.

84. The unreasonable searches and seizures were not otherwise privileged.

85. Accordingly, defendants violated Plaintiff's rights, pursuant to Article I § 12 of the New York Constitution and Article II § 8 of the New York Civil Rights Law.

86. Defendant City of New York, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoings under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

87. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained damages.

FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Unreasonable Search and Seizure Under 42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

88. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

89. Defendants subjected plaintiff and his property to unreasonable searches and seizures without a valid warrant and without reasonable suspicion or probable cause do so.

90. Plaintiff was conscious and fully aware of the unreasonable searches and seizures to his person and property.

91. Plaintiff did not consent to the unreasonable searches and seizures to his person or property.

92. The unreasonable searches and seizures were not otherwise privileged.

93. Accordingly, defendants violated plaintiff's right to be free from unreasonable searches and seizures, pursuant to the Fourth Amendment to the United States Constitution.

94. As a direct or proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained damages.

FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION

False Arrest and False Imprisonment Under
New York State Law

95. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

96. Defendants subjected Plaintiff to false arrest, false imprisonment, and deprivation of liberty without a valid warrant or probable cause.

97. Plaintiff was conscious of his confinement.

98. Plaintiff did not consent to his confinement.

99. Plaintiff's arrest and false imprisonment was not otherwise privileged.

100. Defendant City of New York, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoings under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

101. As a direct or proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained damages.

SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION

False Arrest and False Imprisonment Under
42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

102. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

103. Defendants violated the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments by wrongfully and illegally arresting, detaining and imprisoning Plaintiff without probable cause.

104. The wrongful, unjustifiable, and unlawful apprehension, arrest, detention, and imprisonment of Plaintiff was carried out without a valid warrant, without Plaintiff's consent, and without probable cause or reasonable suspicion.

105. At all relevant times, defendants acted forcibly in apprehending, arresting, and imprisoning Plaintiff.

106. As a direct or proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained damages.

SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Assault and Battery Under
New York State Law

107. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

108. At all relevant times, defendants caused Plaintiff to fear for his physical wellbeing and safety and placed him in apprehension of immediate harmful or offensive touching.

109. Defendants engaged in and subjected Plaintiff to immediate harmful or offensive touching and battered him without consent or justification.

110. Due to the intentional, willful and unlawful acts of defendants, Plaintiff suffered damages.

111. Defendant City, as employer of the individual defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

112. As a direct or proximate result of this breach, Plaintiff sustained damages.

EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Excessive Force Under
42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

113. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

114. The Defendants violated Plaintiff's rights under the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments, because they used unreasonable force without consent.

115. Defendants engaged in and subjected Plaintiff to immediate harmful or offensive touching and battered him without consent.

116. As a direct or proximate result of this breach, Plaintiff sustained damages.

NINTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Malicious Prosecution Under
New York State Law

117. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

118. Defendants initiated the prosecution against Plaintiff.

119. Defendants lacked probable cause to believe Plaintiff was guilty or that the prosecution could succeed.

120. Defendants acted with malice, which, in the absence of probable cause, may be inferred.

121. The prosecution was terminated in Plaintiff's favor, when all criminal charges were unconditionally dismissed and sealed.

122. Due to the intentional, willful and unlawful acts of Defendants, Plaintiff suffered significant damages.

123. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

124. As a direct or proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages.

TENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Malicious Prosecution Under
42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

125. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

126. Defendants initiated the prosecution against Plaintiff.

127. Defendants lacked probable cause to believe Plaintiff was guilty or that the prosecution would succeed.

128. Defendants acted with malice, which, in the absence of probable cause, may be inferred.

129. The prosecution was terminated in Plaintiff's favor, when all criminal charges were unconditionally dismissed and sealed.

130. Accordingly, defendants violated Plaintiff's Fourth and Fourteenth Amendment rights.

131. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained damages.

ELEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Malicious Abuse of Process Under
New York State Law

132. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

133. Defendants arrested, detained and caused a criminal prosecution to be initiated or maintained against Plaintiff to compel the compliance or forbearance of some act.

134. Defendants had no excuse or justification to forcibly detain or initiate a prosecution against Plaintiff, especially with the absence of any cognizable probable cause.

135. Defendants intended to inflict substantial harm upon Plaintiff.

136. Defendants acted to achieve a collateral purpose, beyond or in addition to Plaintiff's criminal prosecution.

137. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

138. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained damages.

TWELFTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Malicious Abuse of Process Under
42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

139. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

140. Defendants arrested, detained and caused a criminal prosecution to be initiated or maintained against Plaintiff to compel the compliance or forbearance of some act.

141. Defendants had no excuse or justification to forcibly detain and initiate a prosecution against Plaintiff, especially with the absence of any cognizable probable cause.

142. Defendants intended to inflict substantial harm upon Plaintiff.

143. Defendants acted to achieve a collateral purpose, beyond or in addition to Plaintiff's criminal prosecution.

144. Defendants' actions violated Plaintiff's rights under the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution.

145. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained damages.

THIRTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Denial of Right to Fair Trial Under New York State Law

146. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

147. Defendants fabricated false evidence to be used against Plaintiff that was likely to influence a jury's decision.

148. Defendants forwarded said false information to prosecutors.

149. Defendants' actions resulted in post-arraignment restrictions and deprivations upon plaintiff's liberty and freedom of movement.

150. Accordingly, defendants violated Plaintiff's rights under Article I §§ 1, 2, 6 and 9 of the New York Constitution, and Article II §§ 10 and 12 of the New York Civil Rights Law.

151. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

152. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained damages.

FOURTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Denial of Rights to Fair Trial & Due Process Under
42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

153. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.
154. Defendants fabricated false evidence to be used against Plaintiff that was likely to influence a jury's decision.
155. Defendants forwarded said false information to prosecutors.
156. Defendants' actions resulted in post-arraignment restrictions and deprivations upon plaintiff's liberty and freedom of movement.
157. Accordingly, defendants violated Plaintiff's right to fair trial, pursuant to the Fifth, Sixth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution.
158. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained damages.

FIFTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Biased Based Profiling under
New York City Law

159. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.
160. Defendants impermissibly relied upon Plaintiff's actual or perceived race, color, national origin, ancestry, citizenship status, gender, religion, religious practice, age, disability or sexual orientation, as the determinative factor in initiating law enforcement action against Plaintiff, rather than Plaintiff's behavior or other information or circumstances that would link Plaintiff to suspected unlawful activity.
161. Accordingly, defendants violated Plaintiff's rights, under New York City Administrative Code § 14-151.
162. Defendant City, as employer of the individual defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.
163. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained damages.

SIXTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Deprivation of Rights & Denial of Equal Protection of the Laws Under
New York State law

164. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.
165. Plaintiff, as an African American male, is a member of a racial minority and protected class.
166. Defendants discriminated against Plaintiff based on race, color, national origin or ancestry.
167. Defendants selectively treated Plaintiff in comparison to others similarly situated.
168. Defendants' discriminatory treatment of Plaintiff was based on impermissible considerations, such as race, color, ethnicity, an intent to inhibit or punish Plaintiff for the exertion of his Constitutional rights, or a malicious or bad faith intent to injure Plaintiff.
169. Defendants applied facially neutral laws against Plaintiff in a discriminatory manner.
170. Defendants, motivated by discriminatory animus, applied facially neutral statutes with adverse effects against Plaintiff.
171. Defendants did not possess a rational basis, excuse or justification for applying any laws or statutes against Plaintiff.
172. Accordingly, defendants violated Plaintiff's rights under Article I § 11 of the N.Y. Constitution, Article VII § 79-N of the N.Y. Civil Rights Law and § 296, ¶ 13 of the N.Y. Exec. Law.
173. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.
174. As a direct or proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained damages.

SEVENTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Deprivation of Rights and Denial of Equal Protection of the Laws under
42 U.S.C. §§ 1981 and 1983 Against Individual Defendants

175. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.
176. Plaintiff, as an African American male, is a member of a racial minority and protected class.

177. Defendants discriminated against Plaintiff on the basis of his race, color or ethnicity
178. Defendants selectively treated Plaintiff in comparison to others similarly situated.
179. Defendants' selective treatment of Plaintiff was based on impermissible considerations, such as race, color, ethnicity, an intent to inhibit or punish Plaintiff for the exertion of his Constitutional rights, or malicious or bad faith intent to injure Plaintiff.
180. Defendants applied facially neutral laws against Plaintiff in a discriminatory manner.
181. Defendants, motivated by a discriminatory animus, applied facially neutral penal statutes with adverse effects against Plaintiff.
182. Defendants did not possess a rational basis, excuse or justification for applying any laws or statutes against Plaintiff.
183. Accordingly, defendants violated Plaintiff's rights, under the Fourteenth Amendment.
184. As a direct or proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained damages.

EIGHTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Conspiracy to Interfere with Civil Rights and Failure to Prevent the Conspiracy under
42 U.S.C. §§ 1983, 1985 and 1986 Against Individual Defendants

185. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.
186. Defendants engaged in a conspiracy against Plaintiff to deprive Plaintiff of his rights to engage in protected speech or activities, to be free from unreasonable searches and seizures, to be afforded a fair trial, to not be deprived of his liberty or property without due process of law, or of the privileges and immunities afforded citizens under the Constitution of the United States.
187. Defendants committed overt acts in furtherance of their conspiracy against Plaintiff.
188. As a result, Plaintiff sustained injuries to his person, was deprived of his liberty or was deprived of rights or privileges of citizens of the United States.
189. Defendants' conspiracy was motivated by a desire to deprive Plaintiff of his civil rights or because of some racial, otherwise class-based, invidious or discriminatory animus.

190. The Defendants that did not engage or participate in the conspiracy to interfere with Plaintiff's civil rights, had knowledge that acts in furtherance of the conspiracy were about to be committed or in process of being committed, possessed the power to prevent or aid in the prevention of the conspiratorial objective, and neglected to do so.

191. Accordingly, defendants violated Plaintiff's rights, pursuant to the Fourth, Fifth, Sixth or Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution.

192. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained damages.

NINETEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Failure to Intervene Under
New York State Law

193. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

194. Those Defendants that were present but did not actively participate in the aforementioned unlawful conduct, observed such conduct, had an opportunity to prevent such conduct, had a duty to intervene and prevent such conduct, and failed to intervene.

195. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

196. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained damages.

TWENTIETH CAUSE OF ACTION

Failure to Intervene Under
42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

197. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

198. Those Defendants that were present but did not actively participate in the aforementioned unlawful conduct observed such conduct, had an opportunity to prevent such conduct, had a duty to intervene and prevent such conduct, and failed to intervene.

199. Accordingly, Defendants violated the Fourth, Fifth, Sixth or Fourteenth Amendments.

200. As a direct or proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained damages.

TWENTY-FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION**Negligent Hiring, Training, Retention and Supervision Under
New York State Law**

201. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.
202. Defendant City owed a duty of care to Plaintiff to adequately hire, train, retain and supervise its employee defendants.
203. Defendant City breached those duties of care.
204. Defendant City placed defendants in a position where they could inflict foreseeable harm.
205. Defendant City knew or should have known of its employees' propensity for committing civil rights violations.
206. Defendant City failed to take reasonable measures in hiring, training, retaining and supervising its employee defendants that would have prevented the aforesaid injuries to Plaintiff.
207. As a direct or proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained damages.

TWENTY-SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION**Municipal "*Monell*" Liability Under
42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Defendant City**

208. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.
209. Defendant City maintained a policy or custom that caused Plaintiff to be deprived of his civil rights, tacitly approved of such violative conduct or was deliberately indifferent toward the potential exposure of individuals, such as plaintiff, to such violative behavior.
210. Defendant City's police officers engaged in an illegal pattern and practice of misconduct, so consistent and widespread to be a custom or usage a policymaker must have been aware of.
211. Defendant City failed to provide adequate training or supervision to its employee police officers, including AN, BALENA and BRADSHAW.

212. Defendant City's employees engaged in such egregious and flagrant violations of plaintiff's Constitutional rights that the need for enhanced training or supervision is obvious.

213. Defendant City failed to install or apply corrective or preventive measures to prevent such violative behavior from recurring.

214. Defendant City caused Plaintiff's rights under the First, Fourth, Fifth, Sixth or Fourteenth Amendments to be violated.

215. As a direct or proximate result of this unlawful conduct, plaintiff sustained damages.

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff respectfully requests judgment against Defendants, jointly and severally, as follows:

- a) On the First Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- b) On the Second Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- c) On the Third Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- d) On the Fourth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- e) On the Fifth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- f) On the Sixth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- g) On the Seventh Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;

- h) On the Eighth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- i) On the Ninth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- j) On the Tenth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- k) On the Eleventh Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction;
- l) On the Twelfth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction ;
- m) On the Thirteenth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction;
- n) On the Fourteenth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction;
- o) On the Fifteenth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction;
- p) On the Sixteenth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction;
- q) On the Seventeenth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction;
- r) On the Eighteenth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction;

- s) On the Nineteenth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction;
- t) On the Twentieth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction;
- u) On the Twenty-First Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction;
- v) On the Twenty-Second Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction;
- w) Awarding Plaintiff punitive damages in an amount to be determined by a jury on all causes of action set forth herein;
- x) Awarding attorney's fees and costs, under 42 U.S.C. § 1988 and all applicable state or local laws; together with the costs and disbursements of this action, plus all accrued interest.

JURY DEMAND

Plaintiff hereby demands a trial by jury.

Dated: Bayside, New York
March 31, 2023

SIM & DEPAOLA LLP

Attorneys-at-Law

42-40 Bell Boulevard – Suite 405

Bayside, New York 11361

(718) 281-0400

By: /s/ Samuel C. DePaola
Samuel C. DePaola, Esq.
Attorney for Plaintiff

ATTORNEY VERIFICATION

I, Samuel C. DePaola, an attorney admitted to practice in the courts of New York State, state that I am a partner of [SIM & DEPAOLA LLP](#), the attorneys of record for Plaintiff in the within action; I have read the foregoing and know the contents thereof; the same is true to my own knowledge, except as to the matters therein stated to be alleged on information and belief, and as to those matters I believe it to be true. This verification is made by me and not by Plaintiff, because Plaintiff resides outside the county where deponent maintains his office. I affirm that the foregoing statements are true, under the penalties of perjury.

Dated: Bayside, New York
March 31, 2023

/s/ Samuel C. DePaola
Samuel; C. DePaola, Esq.